Fancy

Bass Chords

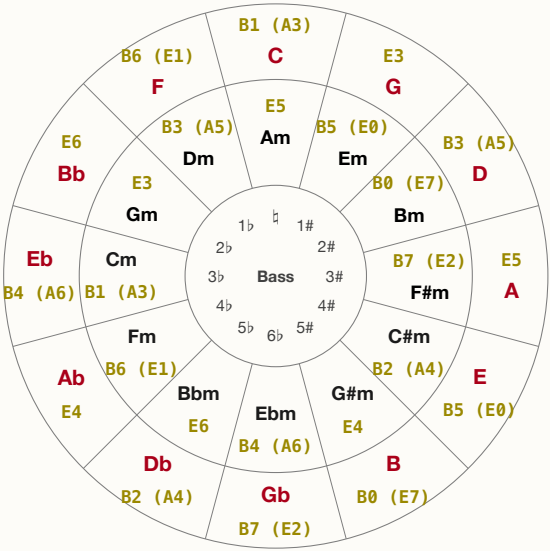
and Their Voicings

(B) E A D G

https://fancychords.com

Bass

Circle of Fifths



String and fret for each root: **A3** is the third fret of the A string.
Lowest that falls under the hand.
Five-string first, four-string in parentheses.

Movable Shapes

Bass closed, so they move

shape	root on	bottom	example
fifths			
02xx	E	R	13xx = F5
x02x	A	R	x13x = Bb5
xx02	D	R	xx13 = Eb5
3x0x	E	R	4x1x = Ab5
major			
02x1	E	R	13x2 = F
320x	E	R	431x = Ab
x320	A	R	x431 = Db
minor			
02x0	E	R	13x1 = Fm
310x	E	R	421x = Abm
x310	A	R	x421 = Dbm

Shape is the fingering above its lowest fret.
Slide it one fret, the chord rises a semitone.
Bottom is the degree on the lowest string.

Numbers

Bass the major scale, degree by degree

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
C	C	D	E	F	G	A	B
Db	Db	Eb	F	Gb	Ab	Bb	C
D	D	E	F#	G	A	B	C#
Eb	Eb	F	G	Ab	Bb	C	D
E	E	F#	G#	A	B	C#	D#
F	F	G	A	Bb	C	D	E
Gb	Gb	Ab	Bb	Cb	Db	Eb	F
G	G	A	B	C	D	E	F#
Ab	Ab	Bb	C	Db	Eb	F	G
A	A	B	C#	D	E	F#	G#
Bb	Bb	C	D	Eb	F	G	A
B	B	C#	D#	E	F#	G#	A#

Read across: in the key on the left, the four is the note under the 4. A minor key borrows the same row, starting from its six.

Root Positions

Bass

	(B)	E	A	D	G
C	1	8	3	10	5
Db	2	9	4	11	6
D	3	10	5	0	7
Eb	4	11	6	1	8
E	5	0	7	2	9
F	6	1	8	3	10
Gb	7	2	9	4	11
G	8	3	10	5	0
Ab	9	4	11	6	1
A	10	5	0	7	2
Bb	11	6	1	8	3
B	0	7	2	9	4

Fret for the root of each key on each string. Everything else is measured from there.

What to Play Under

Bass degrees from the root

major	R 3 5
m	R b3 5
5	R 5
+	R 3 #5
°	R b3 b5
sus2	R 2 5
sus4	R 4 5
6	R 3 5 6
m6	R b3 5 6
6/9	R 9 3 5 6
7	R 3 5 b7
maj7	R 3 5 7
m7	R b3 5 b7
°7	R b3 b5 6
m7b5	R b3 b5 b7
7sus4	R 4 5 b7
7b5	R 3 b5 b7
7#5	R 3 #5 b7
9	R 9 3 5 b7
maj9	R 9 3 5 7
m9	R 9 b3 5 b7
add9	R 9 3 5
madd9	R 9 b3 5
7b9	R b9 3 5 b7
7#9	R b3 3 5 b7
m11	R 9 b3 4 5 b7

Play the root, and the fifth if there is one.
Add the tone that names the chord, the **b3** or the **b7**, only when it wants hearing.
The rest belongs to whoever is playing chords.

Patterns

Bass counted from the root

Root + fifth + octave

The default. Works under anything in the key.

degree	R	5	8
string	R	1+R	2+R
fret	R0	R2	R2

Major arpeggio

Major, maj7, 6.

degree	R	5	8	3
string	R	1+R	2+R	3+R
fret	R0	R2	R2	R1

Minor arpeggio

Minor, m7, m6.

degree	R	5	8	b3
string	R	1+R	2+R	3+R
fret	R0	R2	R2	R0

Dominant seventh

Any 7 chord. The b7 pulls to the four.

degree	R	5	b7	3
string	R	1+R	2+R	3+R
fret	R0	R2	R0	R1

Minor seventh

The two and the six chord.

degree	R	5	b7	b3
string	R	1+R	2+R	3+R
fret	R0	R2	R0	R0

Walking approach

Leading into the next chord.

degree	R	5	6	b7
string	R	1+R	1+R	2+R
fret	R0	R2	R4	R0

Tunings

Bass (B) E A D G

The guitar's lowest four strings, an octave down.

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Downloads and a printable copy:
https://fancychords.com

Source and corrections:
http://github.com/linenoise/voicings

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